

The value bridge: one revenue number, three very different outcomes.

This exists because the same question keeps producing different answers: "what is my stake worth at the \$6M gate?" The honest answer depends on two choices, not one: **which company we've become** (the floor, the thesis, or the bar) and **how we financed getting there** (bootstrapped, one round, or two). That gives a grid of scenarios, not a single number, and the spread across the grid is not confusion. It is the strategy, priced. Below: every input, every layer, every person, sum-checked so anyone can re-run the arithmetic.

START HERE · THE WHOLE DOCUMENT IN ONE TABLE

What each of us holds, and what it's worth in each world.

	A · THE FLOOR \$6M revenue, sold as "services + software" · ~\$51M company	B · THE THESIS same \$6M, valued as one platform · ~\$90M company	C · THE BAR ~\$19M by 2029 at the platform multiple · ~\$250M company
Taylor	~\$16M	~\$26M	~\$70–90M
Kayden	~\$15M	~\$22M	~\$65–80M
Jared	~\$10M	~\$24M	~\$42–52M
Shideler	~\$4M	~\$7M	~\$18–23M

How to read it: **the floor** is what happens if we grow but never earn the platform multiple. **The thesis** is the same revenue with margin at ~65% and product at half the mix. **The bar** is Haven/Delightree speed. Moving left to right is the entire strategy: **margin and mix take you from A to B; speed takes you from B to C**. Everything below is the receipts: where each number comes from, layer by layer, plus what fundraising does to each cell.

All figures: full earn of every ladder, stated multiples, pre-tax, bootstrapped (the fundraising section shows the funded versions). Never promises; always "at these multiples, if we execute."

Three scenarios were being quoted as if they were one.

SCENARIO	WHAT IT ASSUMES	COMPANY VALUE AT \$6M REVENUE
A · The floor	Services and product valued separately (services 6×, product 12×). What a buyer pays if we're still "an accounting firm plus software"	~\$51M
B · The thesis	The platform multiple (12–18×, mid 15×): one integrated financial OS at ~65% blended gross margin, product ≈ 40%+ of mix	~\$72–108M (mid ~\$90M)
C · The bar	Haven/Delightree pace: ~\$19M revenue by 2029 at the platform multiple	~\$230–285M

Older documents (the May equity model) quoted figures like "\$41M post-A." Those were built on a since-retired forecast (\$10M ARR in 2027, the old \$4M-2026 target) and the old cap table, and they are superseded by everything below. The floor/thesis/bar framing replaces them.

The gap between A and B is Jared's margin path and the mix shift. The gap between B and C is speed. Nothing else moves the numbers as much as those two things, which is exactly why they are the two things the whole plan manages.

Cap table positions at full earn, and how the layers stack.

LAYER	OWNERSHIP AT FULL EARN
Accounting arm	Jared 49% (frozen) · umbrella 51%
Line 2 (by the \$6M gate it exists)	Operator ~20% (illustrative, within the up-to-25% template) · umbrella ~80%
Services umbrella	Rollup 51% · Taylor 14% · Jared 14% · Shideler 14% · Kayden 3% (direct, dilution-protected) · team pool 4%
Rollup	Taylor 40% · Kayden 40% · Jared 5% · Shideler 5% · pool 10% remaining

Revenue split at the \$6M gate: services ~\$3.5M, product ~\$2.5M. Within services, accounting ≈ two-thirds of value, line 2 ≈ one-third (illustrative). Entity values flow up the stack: arms → umbrella (via its 51–80% arm stakes) → Rollup (via its 51% umbrella stake). Every person's total = direct arm stake + umbrella stake + Rollup stake. No layer is counted twice.

Separate multiples: services \$21M, product \$30M.

In one sentence: we reach \$6M of revenue, but a buyer still sees two businesses stapled together and prices each on its own.

STEP 1 · ENTITY VALUES

Services system: $\$3.5\text{M} \times 6\times$	$\$21.0\text{M} \rightarrow$ accounting arm $\$14.0\text{M}$ + line 2 $\$7.0\text{M}$
Umbrella's holdings: $51\% \times \$14\text{M} + 80\% \times \7M	$\$7.1\text{M} + \$5.6\text{M} = \mathbf{\$12.7\text{M}}$ umbrella value
Product: $\$2.5\text{M} \times 12\times$	$\$30.0\text{M}$
Rollup entity: $\$30\text{M} + 51\% \times \12.7M	$\mathbf{\$36.5\text{M}}$

STEP 2 · PER PERSON, LAYER BY LAYER (SUM-CHECKED)

	ARM STAKES	UMBRELLA STAKE	ROLLUP STAKE	TOTAL
Taylor	.	$14\% \times \$12.7\text{M} = \1.8M	$40\% \times \$36.5\text{M} = \14.6M	$\sim \mathbf{\$16.4\text{M}}$
Kayden	.	$3\% \times \$12.7\text{M} = \0.4M	$40\% \times \$36.5\text{M} = \14.6M	$\sim \mathbf{\$15.0\text{M}}$
Jared	$49\% \times \$14\text{M} = \6.9M	$14\% \times \$12.7\text{M} = \1.8M	$5\% \times \$36.5\text{M} = \1.8M	$\sim \mathbf{\$10.5\text{M}}$
Shideler	.	$14\% \times \$12.7\text{M} = \1.8M	$5\% \times \$36.5\text{M} = \1.8M	$\sim \mathbf{\$3.6\text{M}}$ + cumulative commissions
Others	L2 operator $\$1.4\text{M}$	pool $\$0.5\text{M}$	pool $\$3.7\text{M}$	$\sim \$5.6\text{M}$
Sum-check	All holders across all layers			$\mathbf{\$51.1\text{M} \checkmark}$

This is the scenario behind the "\$19M" figure quoted earlier (that version counted one layer slightly generously; the clean, sum-checked number is $\sim \$16\text{M}$). It is the outcome if we hit \$6M of revenue **but never earn the platform multiple**: real money, and nobody's best case.

The platform multiple. Same revenue, same cap table, and the company is worth ~\$90M instead of \$51M.

In one sentence: identical revenue, but margin has hit ~65% and product is 40%+ of the mix, so the whole company prices as one financial OS.

STEP 1 · ENTITY VALUES AT 15× BLENDED (RANGE 12–18×)

Company: $\$6M \times 15\times$	$\$90M \rightarrow$ services share $\$52.5M$ · product share $\$37.5M$ (pro-rata to revenue)
Arms: accounting $\$35M$ + line 2 $\$17.5M$	Umbrella holdings: $51\% \times \$35M + 80\% \times \$17.5M = \mathbf{\$31.9M}$
Rollup entity: $\$37.5M + 51\% \times \$31.9M$	$\\$53.7M$

STEP 2 · PER PERSON (SUM-CHECKED TO \$90M)

	ARM STAKES	UMBRELLA STAKE	ROLLUP STAKE	TOTAL (AT 15×)
Taylor	·	$14\% \times \$31.9M = \$4.5M$	$40\% \times \$53.7M = \$21.5M$	~\$26M (range \$21–31M)
Jared	$49\% \times \$35M = \$17.2M$	$14\% \times \$31.9M = \$4.5M$	$5\% \times \$53.7M = \$2.7M$	~\$24M (range \$19–29M)
Kayden	·	$3\% \times \$31.9M = \$1.0M$	$40\% \times \$53.7M = \$21.5M$	~\$22M (range \$18–27M)
Shideler	·	$14\% \times \$31.9M = \$4.5M$	$5\% \times \$53.7M = \$2.7M$	~\$7M (range \$6–9M) + commissions

Same \$6M of revenue. The floor pays Taylor ~\$16M; the thesis pays ~\$26M. And notice Jared: the platform multiple lifts his accounting stake more than anyone's, from ~\$10M to ~\$24M. The margin path he owns is literally the biggest lever on his own outcome.

~\$19M revenue by 2029 at the platform multiple: a ~\$230–285M company.

In one sentence: the thesis, executed at the speed Haven and Delightree just proved is possible.

	HOW IT BUILDS (AT ~\$250M MID)	TOTAL
Taylor	40% of Rollup entity (\$172M) + 14% of umbrella (\$79M)	~\$70–90M
Kayden	40% of Rollup entity + 3% direct	~\$65–80M
Jared	49% of accounting + 14% umbrella + 5% Rollup	~\$42–52M
Shideler	14% umbrella + 5% Rollup	~\$18–23M + years of accelerator commissions

Assumptions at the bar: revenue ~\$19M split roughly half product, accounting ~45% of services value with multiple lines live, platform multiple 12–15× at ~65% blended margin. Ranges reflect the multiple band.

Same outcomes, three funding paths. Dilution hits Rollup, never the umbrella.

Raises happen at Rollup, the product company. That means **the umbrella ladders (14% each), Kayden's 3% direct stake, and Jared's 49% of accounting never dilute.** Only Rollup-side holdings scale down when we take money. Assumptions, stated: a seed costs existing Rollup holders ~10%; a seed plus a Series A with a pool top-up costs ~27% cumulative (existing stakes scale by ~0.73). Both are standard-shaped rounds, not commitments.

ROLLUP STAKES	BOOTSTRAPPED	AFTER ONE ROUND	AFTER TWO ROUNDS
Taylor · Kayden (each)	40%	~36%	~29%
Jared · Shideler (each)	5%	~4.5%	~3.7%
Umbrella + arm stakes	Unchanged in every case. That is the design, and it protects all four of us		

Scenario B (the thesis, ~\$90M company) under each funding path

	BOOTSTRAPPED	ONE ROUND	TWO ROUNDS	WHAT DILUTION ACTUALLY COST
Taylor	~\$26M	~\$24M	~\$20M	~\$6M of paper value across two rounds
Kayden	~\$22M	~\$20M	~\$17M	~\$6M
Jared	~\$24M	~\$24M	~\$24M	~\$0.7M. Barely moves. His value sits in the arm and umbrella, which never dilute
Shideler	~\$7M	~\$7M	~\$6M	~\$0.8M

Scenario C (the bar, ~\$250M company) under each funding path

	BOOTSTRAPPED	ONE ROUND	TWO ROUNDS
Taylor	~\$80M	~\$73M	~\$61M
Kayden	~\$71M	~\$64M	~\$53M
Jared	~\$46M	~\$45M	~\$44M
Shideler	~\$20M	~\$19M	~\$17M

Read the columns honestly and the fundraising question answers itself: two rounds cost Taylor and Kayden roughly a quarter of their Rollup-side paper value. So a raise is only rational if the capital moves us off the floor trajectory and onto the bar: dilution buys speed and probability, or it buys nothing. And the flip side is just as important: because the umbrella never dilutes, nobody at this table should fear the raise. Jared's column barely moves in any world.

One more honest note: a bootstrapped Scenario C is the least likely cell in the grid. Haven and Delightree both raised to hit the paces we call the bar. The realistic best case is "one or two rounds, Scenario C," and those cells still read \$17M to \$73M per person. The raise is not the enemy of these numbers; slowness is.

7 · THE HONEST CAVEATS

What makes these numbers sayable out loud.

All figures are pre-tax, at full earn of every ladder, and at the stated multiples; the summary matrix above is the bootstrapped case, and section 6 shows exactly what one or two rounds do to each cell. The platform multiple in B and C is **earned, not assumed**: it requires ~65% blended gross margin and product at roughly half the mix. If either fails, scenario A is what a buyer pays. These are "at these multiples, if we execute" numbers, never promises.

Read the matrix left to right and it is the whole company strategy in one row: margin and mix move you from column A to B. Speed moves you from B to C. That is why the plan obsesses over exactly those two things and nothing else.